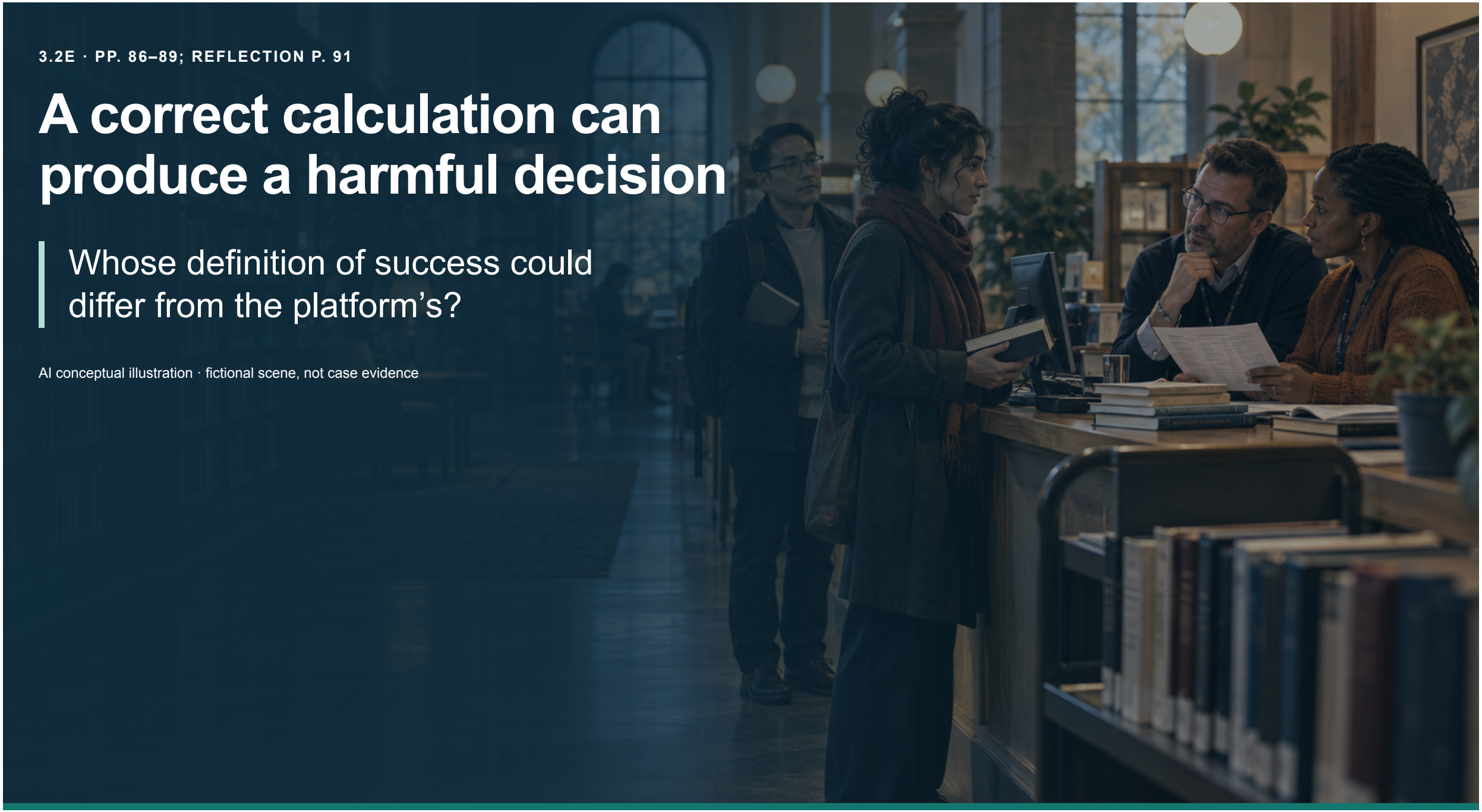
3.2E · PP. 86–89; REFLECTION P. 91

A correct calculation can produce a harmful decision

> Whose definition of success could differ from the platform’s?



AI conceptual illustration · fictional scene, not case evidence

Replacing and supporting human judgement

REPLACE A DECISION

Rule produces final outcome

SUPPORT A REVIEWER

Rule provides information; reviewer checks context and can overturn

Effective review needs useful evidence, time and authority.

Automation can apply a rule consistently at scale

Bomfim et al., Digital Society for the IB Diploma, Hodder, 2022. Printed pages cited per slide. Original paraphrase. Textbook connection: pp. 86–87.

APPLY · 3 · TEXTBOOK PP. 87

Bias can enter at several points

Who is represented?

What proxy or label?

Which objective?

Whose results differ?

Bias can enter at several points. Compare effects for relevant groups instead of relying only on a whole-dataset average.

Data may omit or misrepresent a group

Bomfim et al., Digital Society for the IB Diploma, Hodder, 2022. Printed pages cited per slide. Original paraphrase. Textbook connection: pp. 87.

APPLY · 4 · TEXTBOOK PP. 87

Missing examples can change who succeeds

Examples · teal: Invented training examples · common scale 0–90



A training set contains 90 examples from Group A and 10 from B

Bomfim et al., Digital Society for the IB Diploma, Hodder, 2022. Printed pages cited per slide. Original paraphrase. Textbook connection: pp. 87.

APPLY · 5 · TEXTBOOK PP. 87

A proxy can misrepresent the intended quality

TARGET QUALITY

Reliability for a media event

RECORDED PROXY

Number of earlier events completed

A student with no earlier opportunity cannot build the same count. Investigate access before inferring ability.

Desired quality: reliable access to a task

Bomfim et al., Digital Society for the IB Diploma, Hodder, 2022. Printed pages cited per slide. Original paraphrase. Textbook connection: pp. 87.

APPLY · 6 · TEXTBOOK PP. 87–89

A feedback loop can reinforce an early advantage

1. Exposure opportunity →

2. Recorded interaction →

3. Updated input/score →

4. Next exposure

The output affects later input. An early visibility advantage can be reinforced; an unmeasured group may remain hidden.

Exposure gives an item opportunities for interaction

Bomfim et al., Digital Society for the IB Diploma, Hodder, 2022. Printed pages cited per slide. Original paraphrase. Textbook connection: pp. 87–89.

APPLY · 7 · TEXTBOOK PP. 86–88

Human judgement can erode through over-reliance

UNCRITICAL ACCEPTANCE

Score → accept → repeat

INDEPENDENT CHECKING

Score → inspect input → give reason → allow challenge

Numbers can appear authoritative. A challenge route is a safeguard to evaluate, not a guarantee.

A score may seem authoritative because it is numerical

Bomfim et al., Digital Society for the IB Diploma, Hodder, 2022. Printed pages cited per slide. Original paraphrase. Textbook connection: pp. 86–88.

APPLY · 8 · TEXTBOOK PP. 88

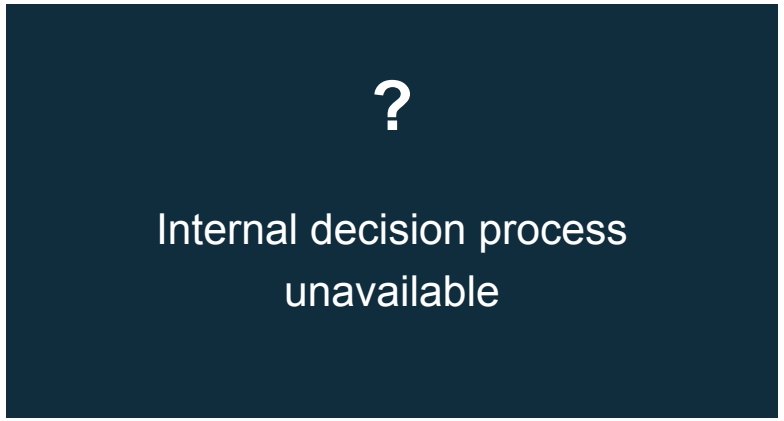
A black box limits explanation

VISIBLE INPUT

History

Duration

Language



VISIBLE OUTPUT

Ranked recommendations

Seeing the result does not explain the internal reasoning.

Inputs and outputs may be visible

Bomfim et al., Digital Society for the IB Diploma, Hodder, 2022. Printed pages cited per slide. Original paraphrase. Textbook connection: pp. 88.

APPLY · 9 · TEXTBOOK PP. 88

Transparency makes parts of the decision understandable

Rule is disclosed	Individual result explained	Limitations made clear

Visibility can help understanding; it does not by itself assign responsibility or provide remedy.

Explain the objective and significant inputs

Bomfim et al., Digital Society for the IB Diploma, Hodder, 2022. Printed pages cited per slide. Original paraphrase. Textbook connection: pp. 88.

Accountability assigns responsibility and consequences

1. Responsible actor →

2. Challenge route →

3. Review with authority →

4. Repair or consequence

A route must be usable and capable of affecting a decision; merely adding a human name is insufficient.

Name who must explain the decision

Bomfim et al., Digital Society for the IB Diploma, Hodder, 2022. Printed pages cited per slide. Original paraphrase. Textbook connection: pp. 88.

Real case A: a provider explains recommendations

2020

TikTok · provider account

Source paraphrase · read the cited original

SUPPORTS THIS CLAIM

Signals and a broad account of recommendation logic.

DOES NOT ESTABLISH

Current exact weights, independent wellbeing outcomes or creator earnings.

TikTok describes interaction and video-information signals

TikTok, 18 June 2020, provider account. Read primary source Textbook connection: pp. 86–89.

Real case C: a regulator examines design risks

6 FEB 2026

European Commission · preliminary finding

Source paraphrase · read the cited original

SUPPORTS THIS CLAIM

A regulator’s concern about addictive design and safeguards.

DOES NOT ESTABLISH

A final legal determination or the exact ranking rule.

The European Commission issued preliminary findings in February 2026

European Commission, 6 February 2026, preliminary findings. Read primary source Textbook connection: pp. 86–89.

Observation, explanation and intention

1. Recorded observation →

2. Proposed mechanism →

3. Contextual consequence →

4. Qualified judgement

State which links the source establishes and which are your inferences. Give a condition that could change the judgement.

Observation: a measured pattern in the results

A conditional judgement weighs an intervention

PROPOSED INTERVENTION

Give new items an initial exposure opportunity

TEST THE TRADE-OFF

New creators: chance to be measured

Viewers: relevant and varied choices?

Platform: objective and appeal route?

CONDITIONAL JUDGEMENT

Recommend only if the evidence supports the criterion and the safeguard works.

Criterion: fair access to visibility

Bomfim et al., Digital Society for the IB Diploma, Hodder, 2022. Printed pages cited per slide. Original paraphrase. Textbook connection: pp. 89.

Paper 1 and Paper 2 use the same knowledge differently

PAPER 1-STYLE PRACTICE

Explain a digital mechanism; analyse people and context; reach a supported judgement.

PAPER 2-STYLE PRACTICE

Use stimulus evidence; compare sources where required; integrate knowledge into a qualified synthesis.

These are short formative rehearsals, not complete examination papers or predicted grades.

Paper 1: apply knowledge to a specified situation

APPLY · 16 · TEXTBOOK PP. 86–91

Chapter 3.2: delayed explanation check

PAUSE · INDIVIDUAL FIRST ATTEMPT · 2 MINUTES

What makes an evaluative conclusion stronger?

Predict / retrieve | Justify with an operation | Check → correct

Save your first response below. Explain the correction on a fresh example; practice is not a mark.

Explain one mechanism without notes

Bomfim et al., Digital Society for the IB Diploma, Hodder, 2022. Printed pages cited per slide. Original paraphrase. Textbook connection: pp. 86–91.